

The Caregiver's Handbook - Printable Planning Sheets

From *The Caregiver's Handbook: Caring for an Aging Parent* by Anne Merriweather (Oro Enigma Publishing). Print as many copies as you need.

Sheet 1 - The needs assessment (Chapter 2)

For each: **A** alone, **H** with help or prompting, **C** cannot. Date it and repeat every three months.

The body	Now	3 months	6 months
Bathing or showering			
Dressing			
Getting to and using the toilet			
Moving from bed to chair, and walking			
Bladder and bowel control			
Eating			

The life	Now	3 months	6 months
Shopping			
Cooking			

Managing medicines			
Using the telephone			
Money and bills			
Getting about (driving, buses, taxis)			
Housework and laundry			

Level (1 independent with support / 2 needs daily help / 3 needs care around the clock): _____ Memory concerns (Y/N): _____ Falls in the last 6 months: _____

Sheet 2 - The medicine list (Chapter 6)

Name: _____ Date of birth: _____ Allergies: _____
Pharmacy and number: _____ Doctor and number: _____
Last medicine review: _____

Medicine and strength	What it is for	When taken	Prescribed by	Notes

Over-the-counter medicines, supplements, drops and creams:

Sheet 3 - The emergency sheet (Chapter 13)

On the fridge, in the handbag, in your phone.

Name, and the name they answer to	
Date of birth	
Address	
Health insurance / NHS number / health card	
Doctor (name, number)	
Conditions	
Medicines (see the list) and allergies	
Hearing aids / glasses / dentures	
Advance directive / DNR: yes or no, and where it is	
Power of attorney (health): name and number	
Next of kin: name and number	
Second contact: name and number	

Neighbour with a key / key safe code	
What calms them	
Pets to be looked after	

Sheet 4 - The home safety walk-through (Chapter 5)

Tick when done.

Area	Check	Done
Entrance	Clear path, sensor light, rail on steps, key safe, doorbell heard	☐
Stairs	Rails both sides full length, clear steps, lights top and bottom, edges visible	☐
Floors	Rugs gone or fixed, cables clear, clear path bed to bathroom	☐
Lighting	Brighter bulbs, night-lights bedroom to bathroom, lamp and torch by the bed	☐
Bathroom	Grab rails (toilet, shower, bath), raised seat, non-slip mats, shower seat, lock opens from outside, water not scalding	☐
Bedroom	Bed height right, chair with arms, phone and alarm in reach, commode if needed	☐
Kitchen	Everyday things at waist height, auto-off kettle, cooker cut-off, smoke alarm tested, fire blanket, a chair	☐
Living room	The chair high and firm enough, phone in reach, no trailing cables	☐
Alarms	Smoke every floor, carbon monoxide, personal alarm worn, key safe	☐
Telephone	Big buttons, numbers programmed, call blocker	☐
Outside	Steps and paths sound, bins reachable, garden not a fall risk	☐

Sheet 5 - The family meeting agenda (Chapter 9)

Date: _____ Present: _____ Chair: _____ Notes taken by: _____

1. What our parent has said they want (read out first).
2. The facts: the assessment (Sheet 1), the medical picture, the money.
3. What each of us can and cannot do (time, money, distance, skills).
4. The four jobs: the hands _____ the head _____ the money _____ the relief _____
5. Decisions for the next three months (who, what, by when).
6. How we will communicate (the group message, the weekly call, the shared calendar).
7. The paperwork (Chapter 4): who is the attorney or proxy; where the documents are.
8. Money: who pays what; a caregiver agreement; reimbursement.
9. The next meeting: _____

Sheet 6 - The care plan (Chapter 13)

Who they are (the name, what matters to them, what they can and cannot do)	
The daily routine (waking, medicines, meals, toilet, activity, bed)	
The week (who comes when)	
The medical (conditions, doctors, what to watch for, when to call)	
The wishes (hospital or home, the directive, the resuscitation decision, the faith)	
The money (who pays what, from where)	
The people (every name and number)	
Review date	

Sheet 7 - The monthly budget (Chapter 8)

Income	Monthly	Costs	Monthly
Pension(s)		Care (carers, agency, day centre)	
Benefits (attendance allowance, VA, etc.)		Housing (rent, mortgage, care home fee)	
Investments and savings drawn		Utilities, phone, alarm	
Family contributions		Food, meals delivered	
Other		Medicines and equipment	
		Transport, taxis	
		Insurance, other	
Total in		Total out	

Shortfall a month: _____ Savings will last (months): _____
 Benefits still to claim: _____

Sheet 8 - The facility or agency visit checklist

(Chapter 11)

Name: _____ Date and time: _____ Announced /
unannounced: _____

Looking for	Notes	Score 1 to 5
The smell, the cleanliness		
Residents up, dressed, occupied; spoken to as adults		
Staff know names; staff turnover (ask)		
The food (eat it); help given to those who need it		
Activities that actually happen; outdoor space used		
Call bells answered (time it)		
The inspection report and rating		
Medical cover (doctor, nurses, pharmacy, dementia training)		
What happens when needs increase		
Fees, all of them, in writing; notice period; rate rises		
Visiting, pets, the room, personal		

things		
Would I live here?		

Sheet 9 - The caregiver self-check (Chapter 14)

Tick the true ones this month: sleeping under six hours ☐ no day off in a month ☐ irritable and ashamed ☐ own appointments cancelled ☐ drinking, eating badly, no exercise ☐ crying easily or feeling nothing ☐ "I wish this were over" ☐ family says they never see me ☐ doing two-person tasks alone ☐ cannot remember laughing ☐

Three or more: arrange help this month. Five or more: help this week, and tell the doctor. **What I will hand over first:** _____

Who I will tell: _____ **My twenty minutes:** _____

